Certo — Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Overview

Certo is a verified Apple product procurement and delivery service for Nigerian consumers. Customers browse a curated catalog, place an order, and Certo purchases the exact device from Apple in the United States. The device is shipped to Nigeria via a freight partner that handles all customs and paperwork, then delivered to the customer's doorstep — with full chain-of-custody transparency at every step.

Certo's core value proposition is trust. Every device is purchased directly from Apple, verified by serial number, covered by Apple's one-year limited warranty, and supported by authorized Apple service providers already operating in Nigeria.

Problem Statement

Nigeria has no Apple Store. Consumers are forced to buy from a local market with zero accountability — where stolen devices are sold as new, refurbished units are presented as unused, and battery health is manipulated. There is no reliable way to verify a device's authenticity before something goes wrong.

The only people who reliably get genuine Apple products are those with a trusted contact abroad. Certo makes that access available to everyone.

Goals

- Give Nigerian consumers a verified, accountable channel to buy genuine Apple products

- Deliver devices to their doorstep with serial number confirmation and warranty coverage intact
- Build a lean, capital-efficient operation where every purchase is triggered by a confirmed paid order
- Establish Certo as the most trusted Apple procurement service in Nigeria before expanding to Ghana and broader Pan-Africa

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Non-Goals

- Certo is not a marketplace. It does not hold inventory or buy in bulk.
- Certo is not a repair service. It directs warranty issues to authorized service providers.
- Certo does not target the enterprise or bulk B2B market in v1.
- Certo does not ship outside Nigeria in v1.

Target Users

Primary: Nigerian professionals, freelancers, and remote workers aged 24–35 who earn in dollars or dollar-adjacent income and need Apple hardware as a working tool. They have been burned by the local market or know someone who has. They spend time on Twitter and in tech communities.

Secondary: Students, content creators, and first-time Apple buyers who want to avoid the fear and uncertainty of the local market.

User Stories

- As a customer, I want to browse available Apple products and see all-in pricing in naira so I know exactly what I am paying before I commit.
- As a customer, I want to verify my device's serial number before I accept delivery so I know it is the exact device purchased from Apple.

- As a customer, I want to track my order at every stage so I am never left wondering where my device is.
- As a customer, I want to know that if my order takes longer than 25 days I will get a full refund.
- As a customer, I want to choose an AppleCare plan at checkout so my device is protected beyond the standard warranty.
- As an admin, I want to manage the product catalog — create, edit, and unpublish listings — from a single dashboard.
- As an admin, I want to update order statuses and push live updates to customer tracking pages.
- As an admin, I want to manage the forex rate in one place so all naira prices update automatically.
- As an admin, I want to see per-order margin and overall revenue in real time.
- As an admin, I want a dedicated log for refunds and disputes so nothing falls through the cracks.

Features

Customer-Facing

Product Catalog

- Browse by product type: iPhone, MacBook, iPad, AirPods
- Filter by condition: New or Refurbished
- Sort by price
- Each listing shows: product images, name, specs, condition, US price for reference, Certo naira price, what the price includes, estimated delivery window, warranty coverage, and serial verification badge
- Out-of-stock items visible but not purchasable

Product Detail Page

- Full product information and honest condition description
- AppleCare upsell section with three options:
  - **AppleCare+** — $7.99/mo or $79.99/yr. Covers one product. Unlimited accidental damage repairs, 24/7 priority Apple support, genuine Apple parts.
  - **AppleCare One** — $19.99/mo. Covers up to 3 products. All AppleCare+ benefits plus theft and loss coverage for iPhone, iPad, and Apple Watch (up to 3 claims per 12 months). Add more products for $5.99/mo each.
  - **No coverage** — standard Apple 1-year limited warranty only.
- AppleCare explanation section: how it works, how to activate it after receiving the device, what the customer needs to do (activate via their own Apple ID after receiving serial number)
- Add to Order button

Checkout Flow

1. Cart review — selected product, AppleCare choice, total
2. Delivery details — full name, phone, address, state
3. Forex acknowledgment (naira payers) — current rate shown, total at that rate, mandatory checkbox confirming forex clause: if rate moves more than 5% between order and purchase, customer covers the difference or cancels for full refund
4. Payment — three options:
   - **USD** via card
   - **NGN** via Paystack. Naira payers must acknowledge the forex clause before proceeding: if the exchange rate moves more than 5% between order placement and Apple purchase, the customer pays the difference or cancels for a full refund.
   - **Crypto** — accepted as a payment option
5. Order confirmation — order ID, estimated delivery window, link to tracking page, next steps

Order Tracking Page

- Public page, no login required
- Customer enters order ID
- Live status timeline with timestamps and human-written notes at each stage:
  - Order Confirmed
  - Purchased from Apple
  - In Transit to US Partner
  - Customs Clearance
  - Arrived in Nigeria
  - Out for Delivery
  - Delivered

Serial Number Verification

- Before delivery, customer receives the device serial number
- Direct link to Apple's coverage checker to confirm coverage and authenticity
- Customer must confirm before delivery is completed

Refund and Guarantee Policy

- Orders exceeding 25 days: full refund, no conditions
- Standard delivery window: 7–14 days
- Forex clause clearly stated at checkout and in terms

Admin Dashboard (Internal Only)

Order Management

- Full order list with status indicators
- Click into any order to view: product ordered, customer details, payment amount, exchange rate at time of order, US purchase receipt, serial number,

freight tracking ID, all customer-facing status updates

- Status update panel per order: update stage, add human note, auto-reflects on customer tracking page

Product Management

- Create new listings
- Edit: price, name, description, images, condition, stock status
- Set status: In Stock / Out of Stock
- Unpublish listings without deleting them

Forex Rate Panel

- Set current buying rate
- All naira prices across the catalog update automatically
- Rate change log with timestamps

Revenue Tracker

- Per-order breakdown: customer paid, USD cost at purchase rate, freight cost, net margin
- Aggregate view: total revenue, total cost, net by period

Refund and Dispute Log

- Flagged orders requiring attention
- Document resolution and close out

Customer Database

- All customers who have ordered
- Order history per customer
- Contact details

Information Architecture

Public Pages

- Homepage
- Shop (catalog)
- Product Detail
- How It Works
- Track My Order
- About
- FAQ
- Contact
- Checkout (multi-step flow)

Internal Pages

- Dashboard overview
- Orders
- Products
- Forex settings
- Revenue
- Refunds and disputes
- Customers

Business Model

Certo earns a margin on the spread between what the customer pays and the total landed cost of the device in Nigeria.

Landed cost formula: US device price (at purchase rate) + freight and logistics ($100–$150 per shipment) + payment processing fees

Pricing strategy: Certo prices significantly below the Nigerian local market while maintaining a healthy per-unit margin of ₦100,000–₦200,000 depending on the product.

Capital model: Zero inventory risk. Every purchase is triggered by a confirmed, paid customer order. No upfront stock.

Revenue targets:

- Month 1–3: 5 orders/month minimum, prove the model
- Month 4–6: 20 orders/month, ₦3M+ net revenue
- Year 1: 50+ orders/month, begin Ghana expansion planning

Operational Policies

Forex

- Customers may pay in USD, NGN, or Crypto
- Naira payers accept the forex clause: if the rate moves more than 5% between order placement and Apple purchase, they cover the difference or receive a full refund. This is shown clearly at checkout before payment is confirmed.
- USD and Crypto payers are not subject to the forex clause
- The admin forex rate panel updates naira prices across the catalog in real time

Delivery

- Standard delivery window: 7–14 days
- If order exceeds 25 days for any reason: automatic full refund
- Freight partner handles all customs, duties, and paperwork per signed agreement
- Contingency buffer communicated to customers at checkout

Warranty

- All devices covered by Apple's 1-year limited warranty
- All devices covered by Apple's 14-day return policy
- Warranty honored at authorized Apple service providers in Nigeria: Mac Center Nigeria, iStore Nigeria, Ensure Services (Lagos, Abuja, and other locations)
- AppleCare available for purchase. Customer activates via their own Apple ID after receiving device serial number.

Serial Verification

- Admin sends serial number to customer before delivery
- Customer verifies on Apple's coverage checker
- Delivery completed only after customer confirmation

Competitive Positioning

	Certo	Local market (Slot, iMall)	Informal abroad contact
Verified origin	Yes	No	Depends
Serial confirmation	Yes	No	No
Apple warranty intact	Yes	Not guaranteed	Usually yes
Authorized repair support in Nigeria	Yes	Sometimes	No
Price vs local market	~30–40% cheaper	Baseline	Cheaper but risky
Accountability	Full	Low	Personal only
Scalable	Yes	Yes	No

Launch Strategy

Phase 1 — Personal Credibility (Weeks 1–4)

- Founder posts origin story on Twitter and LinkedIn
- First 10 orders taken manually via DM
- Every order documented with photos and customer feedback
- Build 10 verified testimonials before driving traffic to website

Phase 2 — Website Launch (Month 2)

- certo.ng goes live with full catalog and checkout
- Founder continues active content on Twitter and LinkedIn
- WhatsApp broadcast list for repeat customers and referrals

Phase 3 — Scale (Month 3–6)

- Paid social targeting Lagos tech professionals
- Referral program: ₦10,000 credit per successful referral
- Begin Ghana market research

Success Metrics

- Orders per month
- Net margin per order
- Average delivery time
- Refund rate
- Customer repeat rate
- Serial verification completion rate
- Customer satisfaction (post-delivery feedback)

Open Questions

- AppleCare activation flow: confirm whether customer can activate independently via serial number after delivery, or whether Apple ID needs to be collected at checkout
- Freight partner SLA: formalize customs delay liability and escalation process in written agreement
- Payment processor: confirm Paystack supports the forex clause flow and partial refund disbursement
- Legal structure: register business entity before taking first paid order
- Domain and brand: secure certo.ng